A-A-41
August 25, 1980

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SODIUM CARBONATE, ANHYDROUS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in lieu of Fed. Spec. O-S-571.

This commercial item description covers two types of sodium carbonate-Type I (Light) and Type II (Dense).

Sodium carbonate is intended for various washing processes, with or without soap as conditions may require, when a moderately strong alkaline material is required, and for the treatment of water.

Salient characteristics:

Sodium carbonate shall be a white, crystalline solid and shall conform to the physical and chemical requirements of Table I when tested as specified in ASTM D 501 (applicable sections listed).

TABLE I. Chemical and physical characteristics

Characteristic		ASTM D 501 Sections
Loss on heating, maxium percent by weight.	1.0	17, 18
Water-insoluble matter in dried material, maximum percent by weight.	0.25	28, 29
Total alkalinity in dried material, minimum percent by weight.	99.2	19, 20, 21
Apparent density, pounds per cubic foot (Type I).	29 to 37	30, 31
Apparent density, pounds per cubic foot (Type II).	42 to 70	30, 31

The issue of ASTM D 501 in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with this requirement.

Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and is the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Packaging, packing, and marking. The packaging and packing shall be in accordance with normal commercial practice and shall assure acceptance by common carrier and provide product protection against loss and damage during multiple shipments, handling, and storage. The shipping container shall be in compliance with the National Motor Freight Classification and Uniform Freight Classification. Marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

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